

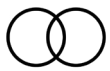
HAVING A CLEAR LIFE DIRECTION | EXERCISE 2

Using the Ikigai Model for Self-Reflection

Ikigai is a Japanese concept that means “reason for being.” The Ikigai model is a powerful tool for self-reflection that helps you find a sense of purpose and direction in life by exploring four key areas:

1. **What You Love (Passion)**
2. **What You Are Good At (Strengths)**
3. **What the World Needs (Impact)**
4. **What You Can Be Paid For (Profession)**

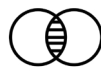
Here’s how to use the model as part of a self-reflection exercise:



STEP 1

Reflect on Each Quadrant

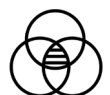
- **What You Love:** Start by listing activities, hobbies, or causes that you are passionate about. These are the things that make you feel alive and fulfilled.
- **What You Are Good At:** Identify your strengths, skills, and talents. Think about both natural abilities and those you’ve developed over time.
- **What the World Needs:** Consider global or local needs and challenges you’re passionate about addressing.
- **What You Can Be Paid For:** Reflect on where your skills and passions align with earning opportunities, including current or potential careers.



STEP 2

Explore the Intersections

- **Passion (Love + Good At):** Find where your passions and skills overlap. What activities combine what you love and excel at?
- **Mission (Love + Needs):** Discover where your passions meet the world’s needs. What causes inspire you and address broader challenges?
- **Vocation (Needs + Paid For):** Identify roles where you can be paid to meet a need. What careers offer financial reward and meaningful service?
- **Profession (Good At + Paid For):** Focus on roles that leverage your strengths and provide compensation. How do these align with your career goals?



STEP 3

Find Your Ikigai

- **Centre Point (Ikigai):** Reflect on where all four areas intersect. This central point is your Ikigai—where your passion, mission, vocation, and profession come together. It represents a balanced and fulfilling life, where what you love, what you’re good at, what the world needs, and what you can be paid for align.



STEP 4

Create an Action Plan

- **Set Goals:** Use your Ikigai to define actionable steps, like pursuing opportunities, building skills, or realigning your focus.
- **Align Daily Actions:** Adopt small, daily habits that support and bring you closer to your Ikigai.